

Bullet points

BULLET POINTS DRAW THE READER'S ATTENTION TO THE KEY POINTS IN A DOCUMENT.

Bullet points are used to create lists. Bulleted items appear in technical documents, websites, or presentations as a way of condensing important information into brief phrases or sentences.

SEE ALSO

◀ 98–99 Other uses of commas

◀ 100–101 Semicolons

◀ 102–103 Colons

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Key points

Bulleted items are used to emphasize important points in a document by separating them from the main text and presenting them as a list. This enables the reader to process essential information right away. The bulleted text can be written as complete sentences, phrases, or single words.

We'll need to be fully prepared for the mission briefing. We'll have to make sure the jet pack is tuned up. We should also get the sewing kit out to finish off the penguin costumes we started last week. Finally, we'll need to dismantle the kite and pack it up as kit.

This running text provides a lot of detail.

SLIDE 1

Before the mission briefing, we'll need to complete several tasks:

- tune up the jet pack
- finish the penguin costumes
- pack up the kite kit

Only the most important information from the text is given here.

Writing bulleted items

Bulleted information has a greater impact if the items are of similar lengths and written in the same way. If the first item starts with a verb, for example, the remaining items should do the same. This creates a balanced list that is easy to follow and gives the items equal importance.

The bulleted items are all of a similar length.

SLIDE 2

On the mission, we'll have to do the following activities:

- go undercover
- impersonate penguins
- follow people
- jump out of helicopters

All of the bulleted items begin with verbs.